

From Person-Specific Dynamics to Population Inference: A Meta-Analytic Structural Equation Modeling Framework for Multilevel Dynamic Models

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This research was made possible by the Prevention and Methodology Training Program (PAMT) funded by a T32 training grant (T32 DA017629 MPIs: J. Maggs & S. Lanza) from the National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA).

Your grants here...

Computations for this research were performed on the Pennsylvania State University's Institute for Computational and Data Sciences' Roar supercomputer using SLURM for job scheduling (Yoo et al., 2003), GNU Parallel to run the simulations in parallel (Tange, 2021), and Apptainer to ensure a reproducible software stack (Kurtzer et al., 2017, 2021).

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Links

Research Compendium

The data and materials for this study are available on OSF (<https://osf.io/uenr7>) and GitHub (<https://github.com/jeksterslab/manMetaVAR>, <https://jeksterslab.github.io/manMetaVAR/index.html>).

fitVARMxID R Package

Source code and documentation for the `fitVARMxID` R package are available on GitHub (<https://github.com/jeksterslab/fitVARMxID>, <https://jeksterslab.github.io/fitVARMxID/index.html>).

metaDyn R Package

Source code and documentation for the `metaDyn` R package are available on GitHub (<https://github.com/jeksterslab/metaDyn>, <https://jeksterslab.github.io/metaDyn/index.html>).

Single Replication from the Simulation Study

This vignette presents a complete walk-through of one representative Monte Carlo replication, including data generation, estimation for each competing method, and selected output and diagnostics. Convergence diagnostics for a representative BMLVAR replication, including PSR, ESS, and trace plots, are provided via the `Mplus` output section of the simulation-replication vignette.

<https://jeksterslab.github.io/manMetaVAR/articles/sim-rep.html>

Empirical Illustration: Meta-Analysis of Affect Dynamics

This vignette reproduces the empirical example reported in the manuscript, including data preprocessing, person-specific VAR estimation, second-stage meta-analytic synthesis, and the resulting population-level affect-dynamics summaries.

<https://jeksterslab.github.io/manMetaVAR/articles/empirical.html>

Benchmarking MetaVAR Against Naive Two-Stage Estimation and Bayesian Multilevel VAR

This vignette reports the benchmarking analysis comparing the computational demands of MetaVAR, the uncorrected two-stage benchmark, and BMLVAR under a common simulation setting.

<https://jeksterslab.github.io/manMetaVAR/articles/benchmark.html>

Containers for Reproducibility

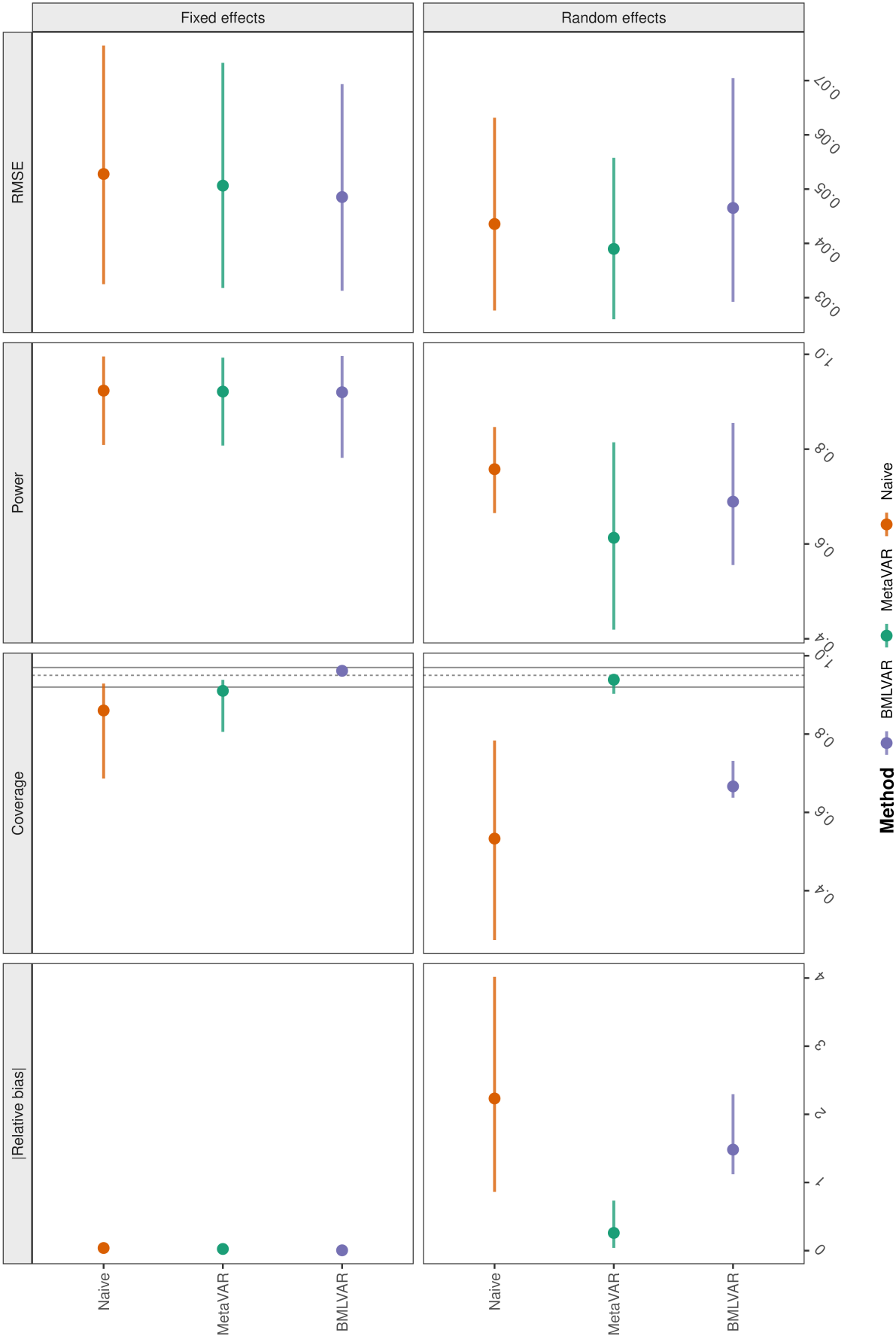
This vignette provides the containerized computing environments and step-by-step instructions needed to reproduce the analyses with the required software stack and dependencies.

<https://jeksterslab.github.io/manMetaVAR/articles/containers.html>

Figure 1
Overall Performance

Overall method performance across simulation design cells

Points are means across design cells; horizontal lines show the min-max range. Coverage panels include nominal .95 and Bradley's liberal .92-.97 band.



Coverage heatmap by parameter, design cell, and method

Figure 1 displays the coverage of 95% confidence intervals for fixed and random effects across different models and parameters. The figure is organized into a 3x2 grid of heatmaps, with columns representing 'Fixed effects' and 'Random effects', and rows representing different models: 'Naive', 'BMLVAR', and 'MetaVAR'.

The parameters being estimated are listed on the left side of each row:

- Naive:** SP 1, SP 2, AR 1->1, CL 1->2, CL 2->1, AR 2->2
- BMLVAR:** Var(SP 1), Cov(SP 1, SP 2), Var(SP 2), Var(AR 1->1), Cov(AR 1->1, CL 1->2), Cov(AR 1->1, CL 2->1), Cov(AR 1->1, AR 2->2), Var(CL 1->2), Cov(CL 1->2, CL 2->1), Cov(CL 1->2, AR 2->2), Var(CL 2->1), Cov(CL 2->1, AR 2->2), Var(AR 2->2)
- MetaVAR:** SP 1, SP 2, AR 1->1, CL 1->2, CL 2->1, AR 2->2

The x-axis for each heatmap represents the sample size (N) and the time point (T). The y-axis represents the parameter being estimated. The color scale on the right indicates the coverage of the 95% confidence intervals, ranging from -0.75 (dark red) to 0.00 (white). The legend indicates that coverage values are: -0.75, -0.50, -0.25, 0.00.

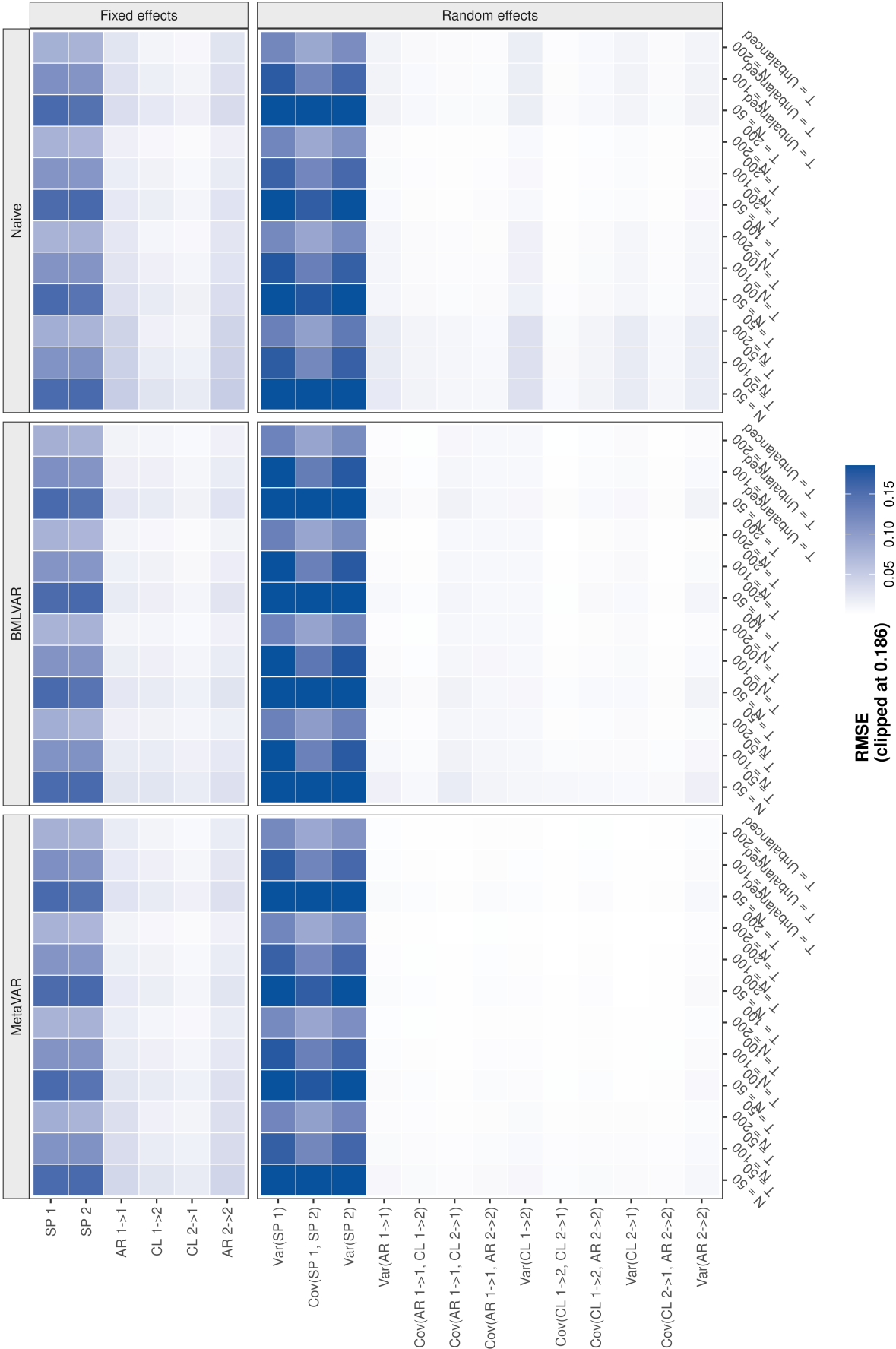
Absolute value of the relative bias heatmap by parameter, design cell, and method

Smaller values are better. The heatmap shows magnitude only, not direction.

Figure 4
RMSE

RMSE heatmap by parameter, design cell, and method

To keep the heatmap readable, RMSE is clipped at the 95th percentile.



Smaller values are better. RMSE is on the original parameter scale, so comparisons are most meaningful within parameter.

Power heatmap by parameter, design cell, and method

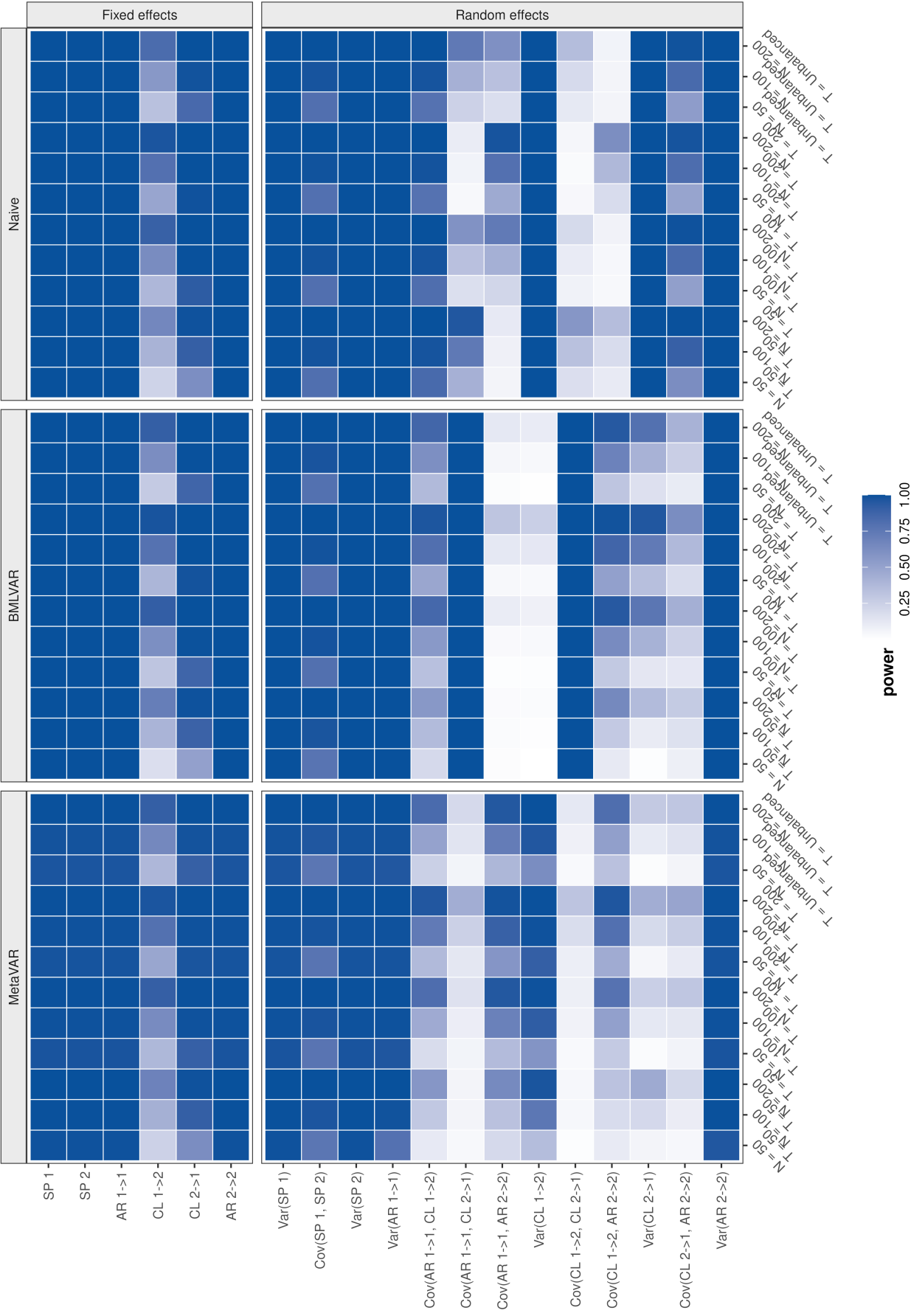


Figure 5
Power